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Tech

The Productivity App That Doesn't Care If You Succeed

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There's no shortage of productivity apps out there. They promise clearer minds, perfectly organized tasks, lower stress levels, and a life so optimized it practically runs itself. And yet, chances are you're not using a single one right now.

Let's be honest. There is no panacea. No magical app that fixes your habits, eliminates procrastination, and makes wasted time disappear forever. The “do-everything” solution doesn't exist, no matter how polished the landing page looks.

After bouncing between tools, systems, and good intentions, I started looking at productivity from a different angle—not another framework to maintain, but a simpler approach that actually sticks. That's what I want to share here.

The Pros of Productivity Tools

An app just for logging tasks isn't enough. The reason people use productivity tools is because they help you with two key things:

- Planning – organizing your day and your goals
- Awareness – understanding where your time is slipping away so you can optimize it

These are valuable functions, but they come with caveats.

The Hidden Costs

Most so-called life-saving productivity apps quietly make your life miserable over time. Once you start using one, you can get trapped in a never-ending cycle of notifications, gamified rewards, and constant performance checks. They push you to stay “in the flow,” but forget one crucial truth: human value isn't measured by efficiency.

People on their deathbeds don't say, “Damn, I wish I had been more productive.” They say, “I wish I had been true to myself and spent more time with the people I love.” Yet most productivity apps measure success purely by tasks checked off.

Would spending time with your parents before they pass count as “unproductive”? Of course not. Or at least, it shouldn't. Yet most apps wouldn't call this productive time either, you didn't finish your tasks to get closer to your career goals after all. This is the key point: productivity isn't universal—it's deeply personal.

A Different Approach

So what would a productivity app look like if it respected your personal definition of meaningful time? One that didn't just track tasks, but helped you see where your time is slipping away—time you could be spending with loved ones, working out, or pursuing goals that matter to you?

What if less was more? You don't need charts, graphs, and endless insights that make you feel guilty. What you need is brutal honesty. Just a single number on the screen representing your wasted time—not judging, not pushing, just showing the truth.

For me, seeing a number like 3 hours and 14 minutes wasted in a day is enough. That simple figure makes me pause. It reminds me of life slipping by and nudges me to change. The next day, I find myself replacing doomscrolling, binge-watching, or other wasted habits with time spent talking to friends, going for a walk, or simply resting.

Introducing 'Wasted'

After thinking about this for a few days, I realized the solution is surprisingly simple: a stopwatch app.

The app is called Wasted. Here's how it works:

- Click a button to start counting your wasted time
- Click another button to stop

That's it. No tasks, no reminders, no gamified achievements. Just raw, undeniable truth about how you spend your time. The simplicity is liberating—and strangely motivating.

Wasted doesn't care if you succeed. It doesn't tell you what to do. It just shows you the life you're living, minute by minute, and leaves the rest up to you.

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